

Capture → Edit

1 / 2

THE ONE RULE THAT PROTECTS EVERYTHING

The master is never touched. Full resolution, native ratio, borderless, flattened once, exported once. Every print size is derived from it — nothing is ever resized or resampled inside the master itself.

1 — IMPORT (CARD → LIGHTROOM)

- 1 Plug in the card. Open Lightroom, go straight to Import — skip manually copying to a drive first.
- 2 Choose **Copy** (never Move) from the card.
- 3 File Handling → check **Make a Second Copy To:**, point it at a second drive. Instant redundancy, no extra step later.
- 4 Destination → **Organize: By Date**.

2 — CULL & RATE

- 1 Turn on **Auto Advance** (Photo menu) first.
- 2 First pass: **X** to reject — don't delete outright yet.
- 3 Use **N** Survey view to compare near-duplicate burst shots side by side.
- 4 Rate keepers 3–5 stars.
- 5 Batch-clear: **Photo > Delete Rejected Photos**.

3 — DEVELOP (LIGHTROOM)

- 1 Exposure, white balance, color, lens correction — all here.
- 2 No cropping in Lightroom. Crop is decided later, in Photoshop, non-destructively.

4 — SEND TO PHOTOSHOP

- 1 Right-click → **Edit In > Photoshop** (with Lightroom adjustments).
- 2 Opens a full-resolution copy, still linked to the catalog.

5 — EDIT & CROP (PHOTOSHOP)

- 1 Retouch, dodge/burn, composite — normal pixel work.
- 2 Need a different crop mid-edit? Press **C**, crop freeform for content — never to force a print ratio.
- 3 Leave **Delete Cropped Pixels** unchecked — stays adjustable later.
- 4 Never use Image Size to shrink the file. Ever.

6 — EXPORT THE MASTER

- 1 **Layer > Flatten Image**.
- 2 **File > Export > Export As** — leave Width/Height untouched.
- 3 Quality **10** (max), or TIFF for true lossless.
- 4 Check both **Convert to sRGB** and **Embed Color Profile**.
- 5 Save to **garage/prints/masters/**.
- 6 Keep the layered PSD too — that's your real, permanent negative.

Print → Production

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File > Print — never Image > Image Size. Print scales the page, not the file. The document on disk never changes.

1 — HOME TEST PRINT

- 1 `Ctrl` + `P` → Color Management → `Photoshop Manages Colors`.
- 2 Printer Profile → match the exact paper loaded now (glossy and matte are different profiles).
- 3 Open the OS print driver settings → turn its color management `OFF` (avoids double conversion — washed-out or oversaturated prints).
- 4 Position & Size → type the real target size into Height/Width: `8×10` / `11×14` / `16×20`.
- 5 Print. Swap paper, swap only the Printer Profile, print again.

2 — RESOLUTION GUT-CHECK

Check `Image > Image Size` before you trust the print. Long-edge pixels needed:

Size	300 dpi	200 dpi floor
8×10	3000 px	2000 px
11×14	4200 px	2800 px
16×20	6000 px	4000 px

Below the floor → sells smaller, or not at that size. Never upscaled silently.

3 — GREEN LIGHT

- 1 Glossy *and* matte both look right at home **and** the size clears the floor above → ready.
- 2 Master already in `garage/prints/masters/` → tell Claude to run it.
- 3 Pipeline derives 8×10 / 11×14 / 16×20 with white borders + a proof sheet, flags anything under-resolved.

4 — PRODUCTION SAMPLE

- 1 Order the hero size as a FinerWorks sample before listing it for sale.
- 2 B&W tonal neutrality (no green/magenta cast) is the thing to judge.
- 3 Matches your home print's intent → approve → list.

5 — CATALOG CARE

- 1 Live catalog lives on the **internal** drive. Always.
- 2 Backups → external SSD is fine. Catalog Settings → back up `every` `exit` while unstable, `weekly` once healthy.
- 3 Run `File > Optimize Catalog` periodically.

6 — IF IT CRASHES: RECOVER

- 1 `File > Open Catalog` → pick a dated backup folder.
- 2 Confirm it opens clean, then `File > Save Catalog As` → save it onto the internal drive.
- 3 Keep working from that internal copy — never settle back onto the external drive.